The God of Cake

By Allie Brosh

ALLIE: (Pg 54-75) My mom baked the most fantastic cake for my grandfather's birthday. [It] was slathered in thick frosting and topped with creatures my mom crafted out of mini-marshmallows and toothpicks. To a four-year-old, it was a thing of wonder—half toy, half cake, and all glorious possibility. *(mimics Mom)* "This is for Grandpa, not for you!"

Mom knew that it was extremely important to keep the cake away from me because if I was allowed even a tiny amount of sugar, not only would I become intensely hyperactive, but the entire scope of my existence would funnel down to the singular goal of ingesting more sugar. ***Cake. Caaake. Cake. Cake. Cake. Cake.***

I managed to climb onto the counter and grab a handful while my mom's back was turned, [and] an irreversible chain reaction was set into motion. ***Cake. Cake. Cake. Cake. Cake.*** I had tasted cake and there was no going back. My tiny body morphed into a writhing mass of

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tenacity encased in desperation. ***Cake is the only thing that matters!***

INTRODUCTION

Will little Allie get her sugar fix and ride the marshmallow giraffe of awesome or will the grown-ups keep her from her ultimate goal of becoming . . .

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ALLIE: Mom had prepared the cake early in the day to get the task out of the way. She thought she was being efficient, but really she had only ensured that she would be forced to spend the whole day protecting the cake from my all-encompassing need to eat it. I followed her around doggedly, hoping that she would set the cake down—just for a moment.

Mom quickly tired of having to hold the cake out of my reach. She tried putting [it] on top of the refrigerator, *(climbing like a mountain goat)* but my freakish climbing abilities soon proved [that] to be an unsatisfactory solution. *(Mom sweeps in to grab Allie down from a precarious perch and Allie throws a fit)*

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Her next attempt at cake security involved putting the cake in the refrigerator and placing a very heavy box in front of the door. The box was far too heavy for me to move. When I discovered that I couldn't move the box, I decided that the next-best strategy would be to dramatically throw my body against it. *(demonstrates)* Surprisingly, this tactic did ***not*** garner much sympathy. *(mimics Mom, unimpressed, arms crossed)* "Get up. Go play with your toys."

I went and played vengefully with my toys for the rest of the afternoon, *(pantomimes playing with toys, nicely at first, but turning violent)* but I did ***not*** enjoy it. All of my toys died horrible deaths. But I never lost sight of my goal. Mom finally came to get me. She handed me a dress because we were leaving for the party soon. *(smiling mischievously)* I put the dress on backward just to make her life slightly more difficult. I was herded into the car and strapped into my car seat.

As if to taunt me, my mom placed the cake in the passenger seat, just out of my reach. We arrived at my grandparents' house and I was immediately accosted by

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my doting grandmother while my mom walked away holding the cake! *(struggling against grandma)* I could see my mom and the cake disappearing into the hallway as I watched helplessly. I struggled against my grandmother's loving embrace, but my efforts were futile.

I heard the sound of a door shutting. Mom had locked the cake in the back bedroom. How was I going to get to it ***now***? I hadn't yet learned the art of lock-picking and I wasn't strong enough to kick the door in. *(wailing)* My life's aspirations were slipping away in a landslide of tragedy. How could they do this to me? I couldn't take it. My little mind began to crumble. And then, right there in my grandmother's arms, I lapsed into a full-scale psychological meltdown. *(stage 4 non-verbal temper tantrum)*

It was unanimously decided that I would go play outside until I was able to regain my composure. I was banished to the patio. *(looks through the glass, as pitiful as possible)*

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I knew the cake was locked in the bedroom; if I could just get them to let me inside . . . maybe. Maybe I could find a way to get to it. I could build an explosive device or some sort of pulley system. I had to try! But at that point, my only ***real*** option was to manipulate their emotions so they'd pity me. *(crying loudly into the glass door, with pauses to see if they are watching)*

I carried on until mom, instead of taking pity on me and inviting me back inside, told me to go play in the side yard because I was fogging up the glass and my sobbing was upsetting my grandmother. *(stomps off, glaring over her shoulder)* Mom would be sorry if I were to die out there. She'd wish she would have listened. She'd wish she had given me a piece of cake. But it would be too late. *(mimics Mom)* "My poor baby! If only I had given her more cake . . . maybe she'd still be alive."

But as I rounded the corner, the personal tragedy I was constructing in my imagination was interrupted by a sliver of hope. Just above my head, there was a window. On the other side was the room in which my mom had locked the cake. *(excited)* The window was

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open! *(shrugs)* -- covered by a screen, but Dad had shown me how to remove a screen as a safety measure in case I was trapped in a fire and he couldn't get to me and I turned out to be too stupid to figure out how to kick in a screen to escape death by burning.

(pantomime as she speaks) I clambered up the side of the house and pushed the screen with all my strength. It gave way, *(jumps into the room)* and suddenly there I was—mere feet from the cake, unimpeded by even a single obstacle. I couldn't fully believe what had just occurred. I crept toward the cake, my body quivering with anticipation. It was mine. All mine.

(proudly, and a little nauseous) I ate the entire cake. At one point, I remember becoming aware of the fullness building inside of me, but I kept eating out of a combination of spite and stubbornness. No one could tell me not to eat an entire cake—not mom, not Santa, not God—no one. It was my cake and everyone else could go *kick rocks.*

Meanwhile, in the kitchen, my mother suddenly noticed she hadn't heard my tortured sobbing in a while. It was

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unusual for my tantrums to stop on their own like that, so she went looking for me. When she couldn't find me anywhere, she finally thought to unlock the bedroom door and peek inside. And there I was!

I spent the rest of the evening, alternately running around like a maniac and regurgitating the multicolored remains of my conquest all over my grandparents' carpet. I was sooooo miserable! But my suffering was small compared to the satisfaction I felt every time my mother had to watch me retch up another rainbow of sweet, semi-digested success.

This is for you, Mom. This is what happens when you try to get between me and cake It didn't matter how violently ill I felt; in that moment, I was a god *(hands on hips, triumphant)* —The God of Cake! —and I was unstoppable! *(quickly covers mouth and turns to throw up)*

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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